# Still Speaking: A Theological Rebuttal Against the Cessationist Misreading of Pentecost

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## Introduction

The Holy Spirit has not retired.

Yet, in modern theological circles, we increasingly encounter efforts to relegate the outpouring of the Spirit and its manifestations—especially speaking in tongues and prophecy—to a museum of early church history. A recent commentary attempts precisely this, claiming that apostolic expressions of power were uniquely confined to redemptive history, not intended for the church today. This rebuttal aims to dismantle that assertion biblically, theologically, and logically.

## 1. Apostolic Activity Is Not Apostolic Exclusivity

The argument that 'apostles and prophets did things not meant for ordinary believers' is a theological sleight of hand that ignores the participatory nature of New Testament Christianity.

Scripture is clear:
“These signs shall follow them that believe...” (Mark 16:17) — not only apostles.
“The promise is unto you, and to your children, and to all that are afar off...” (Acts 2:39)

Spiritual manifestations in Acts are often initiated by apostles but experienced by lay believers. In Acts 10, it was Cornelius and his household who spoke in tongues — not the apostles. The gifts of the Spirit are not badges of office, but gifts to the Body (1 Cor. 12:7).

This is dangerously dismissive logic. Yes, apostles and prophets had foundational roles (Eph. 2:20), but the power, gifts, and signs they moved in were never theirs alone — they were a normative expectation for the Spirit-filled believer. If the same Spirit that raised Christ from the dead dwells in us (Rom. 8:11), why should we expect less?

## End of sample

Thank you for reading the opening of Still Speaking.

The full edition is being prepared for publication.

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